

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK**

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ZAKIYAH HOWARD,

Plaintiff

- against -

Index No. _____
Purchased _____

Plaintiff designates
New York County
as the place of trial

The basis of the venue is
where the tort arose

**CITY OF NEW YORK,
POLICE OFFICER ERROLL CHERENFANT (shield # 10720),
POLICE OFFICER CHRISTIAN GUILTY (shield # 26537),
POLICE OFFICER VINCENT GENNARDO (shield # 3077),**

SUMMONS

Defendants.

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TO THE ABOVE-NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorney(s) within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: New York, NY
July 29, 2022



THE LAW OFFICE OF JODI MORALES
Attorney for Plaintiff
888 Grand Concourse, Suite 1H
Bronx, New York 10451
(646) 582-0400

Defendant's Address:

**CORPORATION COUNSEL OF THE
CITY OF NEW YORK**

100 Church Street

New York, New York 10007

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
NEW YORK COUNTY**

-----X
ZAKIYAH HOWARD

Plaintiff,

Index No.

Verified Complaint

- against -

**CITY OF NEW YORK,
POLICE OFFICER ERROLL CHERENFANT (shield # 10720),
POLICE OFFICER CHRISTIAN GUTY (shield # 26537),
POLICE OFFICER VINCENT GENNARDO (shield # 3077),**

Defendants.

-----X
Plaintiff ZAKIYAH HOWARD, by her attorneys THE LAW OFFICES OF JODI MORALES, by JODI MORALES, principal, complaining of the defendants, respectfully shows to this Court and alleges the following upon information and belief:

PARTIES

1. At all times hereinafter mentioned, Plaintiff ZAKIYAH HOWARD was a resident of Queens County, City and State of New York.
2. At all times hereinafter mentioned, defendant THE CITY OF NEW YORK ("CITY"), was and still is a municipal corporation organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
3. At all times hereinafter mentioned, THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT ("POLICE"), was and is an agency of defendant CITY.
4. At all times hereinafter mentioned, defendants, POLICE OFFICER ERROLL CHERENFANT (shield # 10720) ("P.O. CHERENFANT"), POLICE OFFICER CHRISTIAN GUTY (shield # 26537) ("P.O. GUTY"), POLICE OFFICER VINCENT

GENNARDO (shield # 3077) ("P.O. GENNARDO") were and still are officers employed by Defendants.

BACKGROUND

5. On December 22, 2021, at approximately 8:44 a.m., at the northwest corner of Lexington Avenue and East 125th Street, in the County and State of New York, without just cause or provocation, defendants, including P.O. CHERENFANT, P.O. GUILTY, and P.O. GENNARDO, handcuffed Plaintiff and intentionally and falsely accused Plaintiff of having committed the crime of Assault in the Second Degree (P.L. 120.05 (3) and related charges.
6. On or about December 22, 2021, a criminal complaint was issued at the directive of Defendants and a criminal action against Plaintiff commenced.
7. Plaintiff remained in custody until she was released on or about December 23, 2021.
8. Plaintiff had to defend against false charges until the criminal matter was terminated in Plaintiff's favor on February 28, 2022.

PROCEDURAL POSTURE

9. On December 29, 2021, Plaintiff served a Notice of Claim in writing sworn to on Plaintiff's behalf upon Defendant CITY, by delivering a copy thereof to the officer designated to receive such process personally, which Notice of Claim advised the Defendant of the nature, place, time, and manner in which the claim arose, and the items of damage and injuries sustained so far as was then determinable.
10. More than thirty days have elapsed since service of said notice and defendant CITY has failed to pay or adjust this claim.
11. A 50-H hearing has been held.

12. This action has been commenced within one year and ninety days after the cause of action of Plaintiff accrued.

13. Plaintiff has duly complied with all conditions precedent to the commencement of this action.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION: FALSE IMPRISONMENT

14. Paragraphs 1-13 are incorporated by reference as fully set forth herein.

15. Plaintiff was aware of Plaintiff's arrest and confinement as described in paragraphs 5-7, and Plaintiff did not consent to that arrest or confinement.

16. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and the confinement was not privileged or authorized by any warrant, order, or other legal right.

17. As a result of being falsely imprisoned by the Defendants, Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries. Plaintiff was denied liberty and Plaintiff suffered emotional distress, humiliation and fear and intimidation for Plaintiff's safety.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION: MALICIOUS PROSECUTION

18. Paragraphs 1-17 are incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

19. In arresting Plaintiff, the Defendants acted with malice. The Defendants lacked probable cause to arrest Plaintiff.

20. All charges pending against Plaintiff were dismissed and sealed upon the application of the District Attorney on February 28, 2022.

21. As a result of being maliciously prosecuted by the Defendants, Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries, including loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for Plaintiff's safety.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION: BATTERY

22. Paragraphs 1-21 are incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

23. When P.O. CHERENFANT, P.O. GUILTY, and P.O. GENNARDO grabbed Plaintiff and arrested Plaintiff, they subjected Plaintiff to a harmful or offensive bodily contact.

Specifically, P.O. Cherenfant slammed Ms. Howard's body against a subway station staircase causing her back and neck to hit said staircase. Subsequently, P.O. Cherenfant struck Ms. Howard about the face and head multiple times with a closed. P.O.

CHERENFANT, P.O. GUILTY, and P.O. GENNARDO intended to make that contact without the consent of Plaintiff.

24. As a result of being battered by P.O. CHERENFANT, P.O. GUILTY, and P.O.

GENNARDO, Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries, including loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for her safety.

Ms. Howard also sustained an acute mildly displaced left nasal bone fracture, blunt facial trauma, soft tissue swelling around the nose and paranasal sinus mucosal thickening, including emotional distress specifically, post traumatic stress disorder for which she receives weekly individual therapy sessions at Institute Center for Counseling at Family Health Center of Harlem.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION: ASSAULT

25. Paragraphs 1-24 are incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

26. P.O. CHERENFANT, P.O. GUILTY, and P.O. GENNARDO, acting as the agents, servants and employees of the Defendants, placed Plaintiff in apprehension of imminent harmful or offensive contact. Specifically, P.O. Cherenfant slammed Ms. Howard's body against a

subway station staircase causing her back and neck to hit said staircase. Subsequently, P.O. Cherenfant struck Ms. Howard about the face and head multiple times with a closed fist.

27. As a result of being assaulted by P.O. CHERENFANT, P.O. GUILTY, and P.O.

GENNARDO, Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries specifically, acute mildly displaced left nasal bone fracture, blunt facial trauma, soft tissue swelling around the nose and paranasal sinus mucosal thickening, including emotional distress specifically, post traumatic stress disorder for which she receives weekly individual therapy sessions at Institute Center for Counseling at Family Health Center of Harlem, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for her safety.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants, together with the costs and disbursements of this action in the amount of damages greater than the jurisdictional limit of any lower court that would otherwise have jurisdiction, together with attorneys' fees and costs for bringing this case, and punitive damages.

Dated: New York, NY
July 29, 2022

Yours, etc.,

THE LAW OFFICE OF JODI MORALES



BY: JODI MORALES, ESQ.
888 Grand Concourse, Suite 1H
Bronx, New York 10451
(646) 582-0400

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK****ZAKIYAH HOWARD,**

Plaintiff

-against-

**CITY OF NEW YORK,
POLICE OFFICER ERROLL CHERENFANT (shield # 10720),
POLICE OFFICER CHRISTIAN GUTY (shield # 26537),
POLICE OFFICER VINCENT GENNARDO (shield # 3077)**

Defendants

Index No.

Purchased: _____

I, **JODI MORALES**, an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, state that I am the attorney of record for Plaintiff in the within action; I have read the foregoing and know the contents thereof; the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief, and as to those matters I believe it to be true. The reason this verification is made by me and not the Plaintiff is because Plaintiff resides outside the county where the deponent maintains her office.

I affirm that the foregoing statements are true, under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: New York, NY
July 29, 2022



JODI MORALES